

The lawn at *sunset*, and the people in it

One day to capture what the photographs so far do not show: guests enjoying the restaurant and the lawns, food at the table, and the estate in the last hour of light.

Saturday 19 Sep

Weather permitting

Sunrise 06:01 · Sunset 18:01

Randjesfontein, Midrand

WHY THIS SHOOT

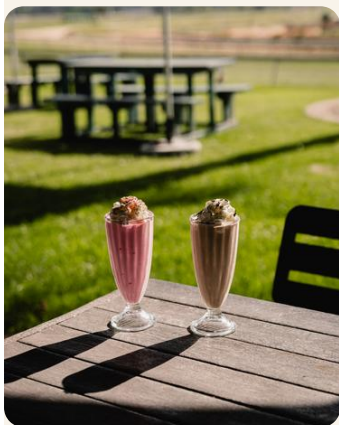
We have the place. We need it in use.

The Acreage already has beautiful professional photographs of the venue, the plated food and the drinks, almost all of them without people. What social media, advertising and the new website need now is the same setting with life in it: people at the tables, food arriving, light on the lawn. Everything from this day will be used on Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, in paid ads and on the website.

THE LOOK

Elegant, soft and natural.

Warm natural light, an airy feel, and people caught mid-moment rather than posed. The images below are from The Acreage's own library and show the light and mood to aim for.



Soft backlight, the lawn blurred behind.



Delicate detail, soft window light.



Long light across the grass.



A dressed table. Next time, with the guests at it.

Natural light

Candid

Florals and linen

Soft, warm tones

Space around the subject

Hands and movement

Heavy, dark edits

Stiff posed smiles

Flash

Glittered backgrounds

THE DAY

Three blocks, following the light.

07:30

SET UP

Walk the estate and dress the tables

Flowers on the tables, linen napkins, polished glassware. Clear bins, cables, stacked chairs and stray signage out of the main angles.

08:00 to 10:30

BLOCK ONE

Breakfast, people and dogs

The light is soft until about ten. Guests eating on the lawn and the deck, coffee being made and poured, a family, a dog under a table.

10:30 to 12:30

BLOCK TWO

Food at the table, the kitchen and the team

Plates going down in front of guests, the pass, a chef at work, the bar and front of house. Shoot food in use, outdoors where possible, rather than on its own.

12:30 to 16:00

BREAK

Harsh midday light

Only interior details if needed. Kitchen closes mid-afternoon, so any remaining plates are done before then.

16:15 to 18:01

BLOCK THREE

Drinks, friends and golden hour

A group of friends at a dressed table, drinks at sunset, then people on the lawn backlit and in silhouette as the sun drops. Sunset is at 18:01.

18:01 to 18:25

BLUE HOUR

Lights on

The restaurant, lapa and tents glowing against a dark blue sky. Twenty minutes, and worth staying for.

If the photographer can only do half a day, book 14:30 to 18:30. That covers late lunch plates before the kitchen closes, drinks and people through the afternoon, and golden hour. The breakfast shots can then be a second, shorter session another morning.

THE SHOT LIST

Twenty-two frames, the must-haves marked.

Shoot every frame upright as well as horizontal. Vertical is what Stories, Reels, TikTok and most ads use, and a vertical photo can be cropped to a feed post, while a horizontal one cannot become a good Story.

BREAKFAST AND PEOPLE

01 Two people eating breakfast on the lawn, mid-conversation
Not looking at the camera. Plates visible but not the subject. The most important frame of the day.

MUST HAVE

02 A family at a table, young children included
A child with a milkshake or a dessert is the frame most likely to be shared.

MUST HAVE

03 A group of three or four women at a dressed brunch table
Laughing, glasses raised, flowers on the table. Speaks to celebrations, baby showers and year-end lunches at once.

MUST HAVE

04 Coffee being poured, hands and steam
Tight and close, three or four variations.

ALSO VIDEO

05 A dog under a table, the owner's legs in frame
And one wider, a dog on the lawn with the view behind. A water bowl being put down is a bonus.

MUST HAVE

06 The menu being read at a table
Over the shoulder, the lawn beyond.

FOOD AT THE TABLE

07 A plate being set down in front of a guest
The server's hands in frame. Movement, not a styled still. Eggs Benedict or the Farmhouse breakfast.

MUST HAVE

ALSO VIDEO

08 A table seen from above, several dishes and hands reaching in
French toast, avo toast, a milkshake and coffees, shared.

09 A sharing platter with people around it
Proof that the food works for a group.

10 Cake and a cappuccino on the deck
Soft afternoon light. The afternoon visit in one frame.

THE TEAM

11 A chef at work in the kitchen, face visible
People behind the food.

ALSO VIDEO

12 The pass, plates going out
Heat and movement.

ALSO VIDEO

13 Front of house welcoming a table
The welcome guests mention in their reviews.

14 Jade and Andrew together on the lawn
One relaxed frame of both owners.

AFTERNOON AND GOLDEN HOUR

- | | | |
|----|---|-------------------------|
| 15 | A table of eight or ten, full, mid-meal or mid-toast
Shows the restaurant takes a group. Function bookers look for exactly this. | MUST HAVE |
| 16 | A dressed long table before guests sit, then the same table full
Same angle both times. | |
| 17 | Drinks on a table at sunset, people softly blurred behind
Rosé, sparkling or a cocktail. Sells the occasion, not only the view. | MUST HAVE |
| 18 | People on the lawn at golden hour, backlit and in silhouette
Beautiful, and nobody is identifiable, which keeps permissions simple. | MUST HAVE
ALSO VIDEO |
| 19 | The sun setting over the estate, wide
With the lapa or the tents in the frame for scale. | ALSO VIDEO |
| 20 | The fire pit or braai in use as it gets dark
For year-end and winter promotions. | ALSO VIDEO |
| 21 | Arrival: the gate, the tree-lined drive, the first view
Late afternoon light. Also the opening seconds of most videos. | ALSO VIDEO |
| 22 | The restaurant and lapa lit up at blue hour
From the lawn, looking back at the building. | |

THE TECHNICAL SIDE

Formats, video and delivery.

Photographs

- **Both orientations** for every key frame, with room around the subject so it can be cropped.
- Leave **clear space at the top** of some frames, for a headline or price.
- Full-resolution JPEG, colour-edited to the soft, natural look above, **no watermark**.



Video clips

- **Filmed upright**, 4K or 1080p at 25 or 30 frames a second.
- **Hold each shot for ten seconds**, steady, on a gimbal or tripod.
- **Sound on**. Real sound from the day, no music added.
- Clips marked "Also video" in the list, plus a slow walk through the restaurant and one of the lapa.

Delivery

- Into **The Acreage's shared Google Drive folder**, never over WhatsApp, which shrinks the files.
- **Twenty selects within 48 hours**, so the best frames can go on the website and social media straight away.
- The full edited set within five working days, with the raw video clips.

Usage rights, in writing

- The Acreage may use every image and clip **without time limit** on social media, in **paid advertising**, on the website and in print.
- Agreed with the photographer **before the day**, with the rate.
- The photographer may use the work in their own portfolio.

PEOPLE

Guests who have said yes.

Real guests may not want to be photographed, and anyone who appears in an advert has to agree to it. The simplest route is to invite a few tables of friends, regulars or team families for the morning and for sunset, and to ask everyone recognisable to sign a short release. Silhouettes and shots from behind need no release.

Four tables to invite

- A couple, for breakfast on the lawn.
- A family with young children.
- Three or four friends, for brunch or sunset drinks.
- A guest with a well-behaved dog.

A release, in plain words

Suggested wording for a one-line sign-off sheet with name, signature and date:

"I agree that The Acreage may use photographs and video of me taken on 19 September 2026 on its website, social media and advertising."

BEFORE SATURDAY

The checklist for The Acreage.

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Photographer booked, with the rate and usage rights confirmed in writing | ☐ Team in clean uniform, and the chef and bar staff happy to be photographed |
| ☐ This brief sent to the photographer | ☐ Lawn cut, and bins, cables and stacked furniture cleared from view |
| ☐ Four tables invited, and the release sheet printed | ☐ A shared Google Drive folder created for the files |
| ☐ Fresh flowers and linen napkins for the tables | ☐ One person named to look after the photographer on the day |
| ☐ The kitchen told which dishes to plate, and when | ☐ Forecast checked on Thursday 17 September |

If the weather turns, overcast light is fine, even flattering, for breakfast, food and people, so blocks one and two can go ahead. Sunset needs a clear evening: move block three to Sunday 20 September (sunset 18:01) or Saturday 26 September (sunset 18:04).